

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4
 ♥ J 10 4
 ♦ Q J 10 6
 ♣ J 7 5 4

♠ K J 7

♥ A K 7 5

♦ A 8 7 3

♣ K Q



♠ 9 8 6 5 3

♥ Q 9 3 2

♦ K 4

♣ 6 2

♠ Q 10 2

♥ 8 6

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A 10 9 8 3

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠9, taken by West with the ♠A. West next plays the ♠4.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 8

You only need one more winner and if ♦s split 3-3 you can easily establish a trick in that suit. But what if ♦s split 4-2? If the ♣J falls you can get an extra ♣ trick. In fact, no matter how the ♣s are arranged you can establish your extra trick there.

First make sure that you win the second trick with the ♠K, keeping dummy's ♠Q for a later entry. Then play ♣K, and ♣Q overtaking with dummy's ♣A. Then play the ♣10, losing to the ♣J but establishing the ♣9 while you still have the ♠Q as an entry.

As you see, you couldn't set up a ♦ trick so the ♣ overtake was necessary to make the contract.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 4
 ♥ 9 6 3
 ♦ 9 3 2
 ♣ K Q J 10

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ Q 7

♦ K 7 4

♣ 8 6 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9

♥ J 10 8 4

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ 9 2

♠ 7 6 3

♥ A K 5 2

♦ A 8 6

♣ A 7 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			

2NT by South

Next time they probably won't and you'll go down.

South is to play 2NT. West leads the ♣K.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=3 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 7

You need to find another winner and the chances are not good. If either black suit splits 3-3 you can establish dummy's fourth card in that suit. But with West's opening lead of the ♣K it is unlikely that ♣s will split. So your only slim hope is that the ♠s split 3-3 and dummy's fourth ♠ will be a winner.

Win the first trick and play a ♠ to the ♠A. Then play another ♠. The defense will win and probably take some ♣ tricks. When they have finished and play a red card, you win it and play a third round of ♠s. If both defenders follow to all three ♠s then dummy's ♠8 is now a winner.

This time you were lucky and the ♠s split evenly.